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Lingua inglese

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PAST SIMPLE

We use the **Past Simple** to talk about:

- actions and situations which happened and finished in the past

  Peter **finished** his homework and **visited** his grandmother.

  I **bought** a new dress yesterday.

  Last year we **spent** our holiday in Rome.

- habitual actions in the past

  Every day we **woke** up at 7 and **went** sightseeing.

  George regularly **had** a cup of coffee before breakfast.

  They always **went** to school by bus.

PAST SIMPLE

Time expressions often used with the Past Simple:

yesterday (morning/evening),

last year/month/week/Monday/night,

in (May/1968/the 1990s), ago, on (day/morning).

Formation rules:

- **regular verbs:** add ***-d*** or ***-ed*** to the infinitive (e.g. love – loved, want – wanted)

- irregular verbs: use their 2nd form (e.g. sleep – slept, go – went, drink – drank)

- **verbs ending with an *-y***: in spelling -y turns into -ie in most of the cases (e.g. study – studied, say – said)

PAST SIMPLE

- **negatives** are formed with *did not* and the bare infinitive

I **did not like** the film. *or* I **didn't like** the film.

I **did not sleep** well last night. *or* I **didn't sleep** well last night.

Peter **did not help** me. *or* Peter **didn't help** me.

- **questions** are formed with *did* and the bare infinitive

Did you **like** this book?

Did you **sleep** well?

Where **did** Peter **study**?

PAST CONTINUOUS

We use the **Past Continuous**:

- to describe a continuing situation in the past, or at a given time in the past

I **was** sleep**ing** all afternoon.

I **was** just giv**ing** a presentation at 3 last Monday.

At midnight we **were** still writ**ing** our homework.

- to describe two continuing situations happening at the same time

Carol **was** cook**ing** while her husband **was** watch**ing** the football match.

While she **was** do**ing** the rooms, we **were** pick**ing** apples in the garden.

While we **were** writ**ing** our homework, George **was** play**ing** football.

PAST CONTINUOUS

- to talk about actions in the past during which shorter events happened – something happened in the middle of something else; for the shorter events/actions we use Past Simple

Matt **phoned** while we **were having** dinner.

It **was raining** when I **got up**.

I **was** walk**ing** in the park when I **met** Peter.

We **were** watch**ing** a film when the light **went** off.

While I **was waiting** for the bus, I **saw** Edward.

PAST CONTINUOUS

But: We use the Past Simple to say that one thing happened after another.

I **saw** Pete in the supermarket. I **went** to him, and we **had** a chat. We **decided** to watch the match together in the evening.

Time expressions often used with the Past Continuous: ***while, when***.

PAST CONTINUOUS

Formation rule: **was/were + V-ing**

Affirmative: e.g. Laura **was** read**ing** all day. My friends **were** wait**ing** for me.

Negative: e.g. Laura **was not** (**wasn't)** read**ing** all day. My friends **were not** (**weren't**) wait**ing** for me.

Interrogative: e.g. **Was** Laura read**ing** all day? **Were** my friends wait**ing** for me?

NOTE: some short verbs double their last letter before the -ing ending. E.g. chat – chatting, beg – begging, drop – dropping.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION!

PAST SIMPLE

Use the appropriate Past Simple form of the verbs in brackets in the following sentences.

1) We _____ (not write) any tests during the semester.

2) The exam period _____ (begin) on 4th January.

3) How _____ you _____ (like) the lecturer?

4) _____ we _____ (have to) hand in our papers before the exam period?

5) I _____ (be not) very fond of giving presentations.

6) We usually _____ (meet) on Tuesdays.

7) As a child John _____ (not speak) any foreign languages.

8) _____ (be) you nervous before the exams?

9) Pamela never _____ (participate) in debates.

10) _____ your teacher _____ (give) you any home assignments?

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KEY

1) did not write / didn't write

2) began

3) did … like

4) Did … have to

5) was not / wasn't

6) met

7) did not speak / didn't speak

8) Were

9) participated

10) Did … give

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PAST SIMPLE AND PAST CONTINUOUS

Use the appropriate form of the verbs in brackets in the following sentences.

1) While we _____ (watch TV) the phone _____ (ring).

2) She _____ (read) a newspaper while she _____ (wait) for the bus.

3) They _____ (dance) when I _____ (arrive).

4) My roommate _____ (get up), _____ (take) a shower, then _____ (leave) without saying a word.

5) How fast _____ you _____ (drive) when the accident _____ (happen)?

6) They _____ (speak) about me when I _____ (enter) the room.

7) No wonder he can't do the task: he _____ (talk) all the time while the teacher _____ (explain) it.

8) It _____ (be) impossible to sleep because the neighbour's dog _____ (bark) for hours last night.

9) We always _____ (spend) the summer holidays in Brighton when I _____ (be) a child.

10) When I _____ (meet) them, they _____ (walk) hand in hand.

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KEY

1) were watching, rang

2) was reading, was waiting

3) were dancing, arrived

4) got up, took, left

5) were … driving, happened

6) were speaking, entered

7) was talking, was explaining

8) was, was barking

9) spent, was

10) met, were walking

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